

wash, and then distilled to capture the essence of the spirit. Over time, the liquid rests in casks usually made of oak, drawing out colour, depth, and nuance as it matures. Years later, it emerges ready to be blended with precision or bottled as a single-cask expression. This is a culmination of patience, craft, and nature, distilled into every glass.

A key distinction of Indian single malts lies in their use of six-row barley, unlike Scotch whiskies, which rely on two-row barley. If distilled in an Indian distillery in a tropical climate, the whiskey matures quite rapidly compared to a Scotch, which may take years to reach a certain pedigree of flavour and finish.

“There are no age criteria when it comes to single casks. Whiskey evolves every day inside the cask. So, it’s like a Mexican wave as it goes through its ups and downs,” says Michael D’Souza, Master Distiller at Paul John Indian Single Malts. Ashar adds, “The flavour profile of a whiskey aged for four years tropically in Goa could be comparable to a 15 or a

16-year-old whiskey from a colder climate.”

Similarly, Damodaran highlights that in Scotland, cooler temperatures allow for a more predictable correlation between ageing and flavour, as opposed to in India, where there is a rapid loss in angel’s share, the amount of distilled spirits lost to evaporation from the cask as the whiskey matures. “We don’t make serious age claims on a product; it’s more about the complexity and personalisation that we focus on,” says Damodaran.

At the heart of Diageo India’s invite-only India Rare Spirits program is a deeply consultative process that treats whiskey creation as both science and art. Clients are first introduced to the “liquid library”, a vault of 22,000 casks in Ponda, Goa, where they explore the influence of core agricultural ingredients such as barley or rice, each with its own distinct flavour profile. From there, they are guided through the fundamental

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**CASK SOLD TO
DATE IN INDIA**

96 |

Whiskey, Delivered Neat

1

Grain & Mash

HIGH-QUALITY
SIX-ROW BARLEY,
MASHED AND FERMENTED
INTO WASH



2

Distillation

DOUBLE-DISTILLED TO
CAPTURE THE “HEART” OF
THE SPIRIT



3

Tasting & Consultation

EXPERTS GUIDE CLIENTS
THROUGH FLAVOUR TRIALS
AND REFINEMENTS

4

Cask Selection

CHOOSE FROM
EX-BOURBON, SHERRY,
RUM, WINE, OR
SPECIALTY WOODS